

ZILIN XIAO

✉ zx51@rice.edu · ☎ (+1) 346-638-2882 · 🌐 Github · 🌐 Web · in LinkedIn

🎓 EDUCATION

Rice University, Houston, TX

2023 – 2028 (Expected)

Ph.D. in Computer Science with Prof. Vicente Ordonez

📖 SELECTED PUBLICATION

1. **Zilin Xiao**, Linjun Shou, Xingyao Zhang, Jie Wu, Ming Gong, Jian Pei, Daxin Jiang. Coherent Entity Disambiguation via Modeling Topic and Categorical Dependency.
In the 2023 Findings of Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (Findings of EMNLP 2023)
2. **Zilin Xiao**, Ming Gong, Jie Wu, Xingyao Zhang, Linjun Shou, Jian Pei, Daxin Jiang. Instructed Language Models with Retrievers Are Powerful Entity Linkers.
In the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2023)
3. **Zilin Xiao**, Ming Gong, Paola Cascante-Bonilla, Xingyao Zhang, Jie Wu, Vicente Ordonez. Grounding Language Models for Visual Entity Recognition.
In the 18th European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV 2024)
4. Pengda Wang[†], **Zilin Xiao**[†], Hanjie Chen, Frederick L. Oswald. Will the Real Linda Please Stand up...to Large Language Models? Examining the Representativeness Heuristic in LLMs
In the 2024 Conference on Language Modeling (COLM 2024) (Oral Spotlight). [†]: equal contribution.
5. **Zilin Xiao**, Ayush Sachdeva, Hao-Jen Wang, Vicente Ordonez. Image Re-ranking with Long-Context Sequence Modeling
In the Instance-Level Recognition Workshop at ECCV 2024 (Short Paper)
6. **Zilin Xiao**, Hongming Zhang, Tao Ge, Siru Ouyang, Vicente Ordonez, Dong Yu. ParallelSpec: Parallel Drafter for Efficient Speculative Decoding
In submission to the 2025 International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2025)
7. Siru Ouyang, Wenhao Yu, Kaixin Ma, **Zilin Xiao**, Zhihan Zhang, Mengzhao Jia, Jiawei Han, Hongming Zhang, Dong Yu. RepoGraph: Enhancing AI Software Engineering with Repository-level Code Graph
In submission to the 2025 International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2025)

👥 SELECTED INDUSTRIAL EXPERIENCE

Mircosoft, Beijing

08/2022 – 06/2023

Residency Research Internship

Focus on aligning large foundation models with entity-related information retrieval tasks.

Tencent AI Lab, Seattle

05/2024 – 08/2024

Research Internship

Focus on the efficiency of large language model inference.

⚙️ ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Teaching Assistant: 2024 Spring - Deep Learning for Vision and Language
Guest Lecture: What Could Be the Next Generation of LLMs?
- Teaching Assistant: 2024 Fall - Reinforcement Learning
- Reviewer: EMNLP 2023, ACL ARR 2024, ACL KnowledgeNLP Workshop, NeurIPS 2024, ICLR 2025

♡ SELECTED AWARDS & HONORS

National Scholarship, Ministry of Education, P.R. China

10/2019

National Scholarship, Ministry of Education, P.R. China

10/2020

Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis Award, Sichuan University

06/2022

Outstanding Student, Sichuan University

2019, 2020, 2021

Star of Computer Science, Sichuan University

06/2022